

Gatekeeper Objections: Practice List

For: Mark and G-Anne | **Campaign:** RIA Outreach

Rule for every call: never hang up with nothing. Leave with a **transfer**, a **callback time**, a **direct line**, or an **email**.

Your mindset: the gatekeeper protects the owner's time. Be polite, short and confident. You are not selling to them. You are asking for two minutes with their boss.

A. Screening questions

1. **"What's this regarding?"** - **Goal:** Give a short, clear reason and ask for the owner again. - **Coaching point:** One sentence only. Long answers sound like sales.
 2. **"Is this a sales call?"** - **Goal:** Answer honestly, then give the real reason. - **Coaching point:** "No" alone sounds suspicious. Always follow it with why you're calling.
 3. **"What company are you with? What do you do?"** - **Goal:** Explain One Wealth Map in one line, then go back to the owner. - **Coaching point:** The gatekeeper doesn't need the full pitch, just enough to pass you along.
 4. **"Does he know you? Is he expecting your call?"** - **Goal:** Be honest without losing confidence. - **Coaching point:** Never pretend to know the owner. Honesty protects trust, and you can still sound calm and direct.
 5. **"How did you get this number?"** - **Goal:** Give the real source and move on. - **Coaching point:** Be specific and honest. Confirm the approved wording with Sam.
 6. **"Can I tell him what it's about?"** - **Goal:** Share enough to be passed along and keep the details for the owner. - **Coaching point:** "Confidential business matter" signals importance without pitching.
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B. Owner not available

7. **"He's with a client."** - **Goal:** Get a specific callback time. - **Coaching point:** "Later" isn't a time. Offer two options, then log it in GHL.
8. **"He's out of the office this week."** - **Goal:** Find out when he's back and set a date to call. - **Coaching point:** Ask about the best day and time, not just "next week."
9. **"He's in meetings all day, every day."** - **Goal:** Find the gaps in his day. - **Coaching point:** Ask when he usually starts or ends his day. Owners are often free early or late.
10. **"He doesn't take calls. Everything goes through me."** - **Goal:** Treat the gatekeeper as your partner, not your obstacle. - **Coaching point:** Ask how they usually get important matters to the owner, and follow

that process.

C. Brush-offs

11. "Send an email." - **Goal:** Get the owner's direct email, or at least a time to call. - **Coaching point:** Accept the request, but always ask for one more thing.

12. "Send it to info@ and we'll pass it along." - **Goal:** Avoid the general inbox. - **Coaching point:** Ask politely for a direct address "so it doesn't get lost." If they say no, ask for a time instead.

13. "Leave a message and he'll call you back." - **Goal:** Leave a short message and still set your own follow-up. - **Coaching point:** Don't wait for a callback. Ask when you should try again.

14. "Just leave a voicemail." - **Goal:** Leave a clear voicemail under 20 seconds. - **Coaching point:** Say your name and number slowly, twice. Time yourself.

15. "We get calls like this all the time." - **Goal:** Show you respect their time and stand out. - **Coaching point:** Agree with them, then keep your request very small: two minutes.

D. The gatekeeper decides

16. "He's not interested." (said on the owner's behalf) - **Goal:** Let the owner decide for himself. - **Coaching point:** Don't argue. Ask if you can send one short note.

17. "I handle these decisions." - **Goal:** Find out if they're an owner or staff. - **Coaching point:** Ask kindly about their role. Ownership questions need the owner.

18. "We already have an advisor / we're not looking for services." - **Goal:** Clear up the confusion. You're not offering them financial services. - **Coaching point:** They may think you're selling to the firm's clients. Explain it's an owner to owner conversation.

19. "We're not hiring / he's not looking for a job." - **Goal:** Clarify without arguing. - **Coaching point:** The conversation is about the practice's plans. Stay calm and ask for the right person.

20. "We're not selling the firm." - **Goal:** Protect confidentiality and keep the door open. - **Coaching point:** Never discuss selling with the gatekeeper. The owner's plans may be private, even from staff.

E. Rules and restrictions

21. "We don't accept unsolicited calls. Please remove us." - **Goal:** Exit politely and mark Do Not Call in GHL. - **Coaching point:** This is a win if handled well. Respecting it protects One Wealth Map's reputation.

22. "All our calls are recorded. He can't discuss outside business on this line." - **Goal:** Respect the rule and find another way to reach him. - **Coaching point:** Don't fight compliance. Ask for the best email or a better number.

23. “Our compliance department has to approve contact like this.” - Goal: Find out the process. -

Coaching point: Ask who to send information to. Following the process shows professionalism.

24. “We’re with [big broker-dealer]. He can’t take these calls.” - Goal: Stay respectful and ask for

another channel. - **Coaching point:** Never comment on their agreements. That’s for the principals.

F. Phone systems and wrong contacts

25. Phone menu (IVR) with no clear option - Goal: Reach a real person. - **Coaching point:** Try the directory by last name first. Then “new clients,” since a person usually answers fast. Note which option worked in GHL.

26. “There’s no one here by that name.” - Goal: Find out if the contact moved or the data is wrong. -

Coaching point: Ask who owns the firm now. Update GHL so no one calls the wrong person again.

27. “He retired / he left the firm.” - Goal: Find the new owner, and maybe where the old contact went. -

Coaching point: This can be a lead. A new owner or a recent change can mean the firm is going through a transition.

28. “He passed away.” - Goal: Respond with kindness and end the call. - **Coaching point:** Offer

condolences. Don’t pitch. Note it in GHL so no one calls again.

G. Outside the box

29. The gatekeeper is chatty and friendly. - Goal: Build rapport and learn useful details. - **Coaching point:** Ask their name and use it. Ask about the owner’s schedule. A friendly gatekeeper is your best ally.

30. The gatekeeper is rude or hangs up mid-sentence. - Goal: Stay professional and try again another day. - **Coaching point:** It’s not personal. Log it, then try a different time. A different person may answer.

31. “Can you hold?” (long hold) - Goal: Use the time well and not lose the call. - **Coaching point:**

Prepare your opening while waiting. If the hold is too long, ask for a callback time.

32. The gatekeeper offers someone else (“Talk to our operations manager”). - Goal: Decide whether

that person can help. - **Coaching point:** Be polite. Ownership plans need the owner, but this person may help you reach him.

33. The gatekeeper asks you to explain in detail. - Goal: Keep it short without sounding secretive. -

Coaching point: Share one line. Save the details for the owner, out of respect for his privacy.

34. You call back for the third time and the same gatekeeper answers. - Goal: Turn repetition into

familiarity. - **Coaching point:** Use their name, mention the last call, and stay friendly. Persistence plus politeness builds trust.

35. The owner answers his own phone unexpectedly. - Goal: Switch from gatekeeper mode to owner

mode right away. - **Coaching point:** Don’t freeze. Confirm his name, then go straight to your opening.

Quick reminders

- **Use first names:** the owner's and the gatekeeper's.
- **Be short:** your reason fits in one sentence.
- **Be honest:** never pretend to know the owner or make up a reason.
- **Always ask for one more thing:** a time, a direct line, or an email.
- **Log everything in GHL:** gatekeeper's name, best time, what worked.
- **Respect "remove us":** a polite exit is a professional win.